

How to Find the Answers of the Passage Quickly

(Keep in mind these 7 POINTS given below and you'll be able to solve passages quickly and accurately.)

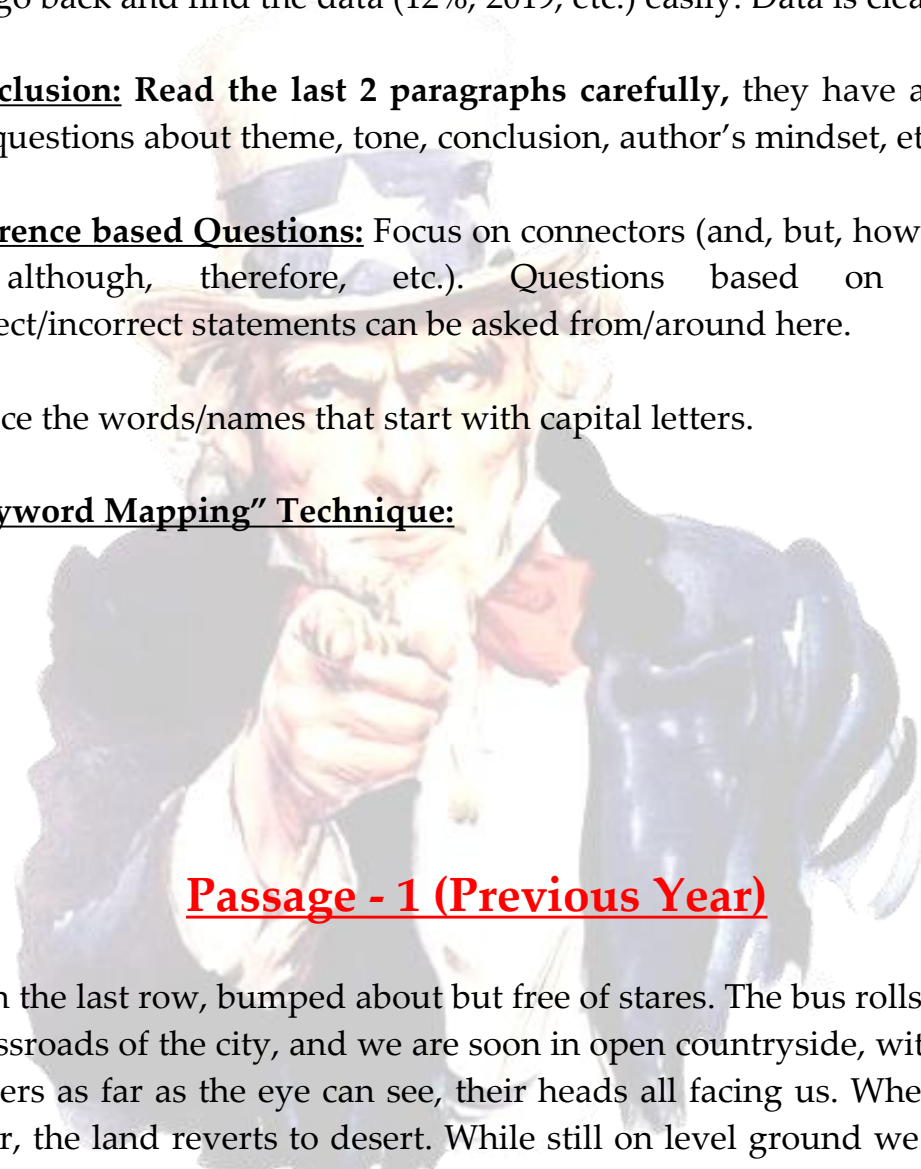
A. Golden Rule of SSC Passage

- SSC does not ask you to understand every line deeply.
- Your goal is to locate information quickly and eliminate wrong options smartly.

B. 10 Types of Common SSC RC Questions Asked

1. Title
2. Theme/Main Idea
3. Tone
4. Vocabulary (synonym/antonym)
5. Statement-based
6. Inference
7. Factual questions
8. Meaning of phrase
9. Pronoun reference
10. Conclusion of passage

1. **Main Idea:** First of all, don't read the passage. **Read the questions first.** If any vocab question (synonym, antonym, idiom/phrase) is asked, answer it right away. After reading the questions, **read 5-6 lines of the first paragraph to get the idea** of what the passage is about.
2. **Title of the passage:** If questions about tone, theme, and title are asked, **always answer the title question first.** Don't go for tone or theme first. For the title question, always **focus on repeating words in the paragraphs.** It helps us find the title of the passage. *The title of a passage is basically like the name of a Bollywood movie, which is repeated throughout the movie in songs, dialogues, etc.*

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3. **Common Questions:** Pay attention **where a paragraph ends and the next paragraph begins**. The author shifts from one paragraph to another to talk about something different, to provide us additional and informative points.
 4. **Data Based Questions:** **Don't waste time reading the data** (year, money, %, rates, numbers, etc.). If the question is asked about data, you can go back and find the data (12%, 2019, etc.) easily. Data is clearly visible.
 5. **Conclusion:** **Read the last 2 paragraphs carefully**, they have answers of the questions about theme, tone, conclusion, author's mindset, etc.
 6. **Inference based Questions:** Focus on connectors (and, but, however, even if, although, therefore, etc.). Questions based on inference, correct/incorrect statements can be asked from/around here.
 7. Notice the words/names that start with capital letters.
 8. **"Keyword Mapping" Technique:**

Passage - 1 (Previous Year)

We sit in the last row, bumped about but free of stares. The bus rolls out of the dull crossroads of the city, and we are soon in open countryside, with fields of sunflowers as far as the eye can see, their heads all facing us. Where there is no water, the land reverts to desert. While still on level ground we see in the distance the tall range of the Mount Bogda, abrupt like a shining prism laid horizontally on the desert surface. It is over 5,000 metres high, and the peaks are under permanent snow, in powerful contrast to the flat desert all around. **Heaven Lake** lies part of the way up this range, about 2,000 metres above sea-level, at the foot of one of the higher snow-peaks.

As the bus climbs, the sky, brilliant before, grows overcast. I have brought nothing warm to wear: it is all down at the hotel in Urumqi. Rain begins to fall.

The man behind me is eating overpoweringly smelly goat's cheese. The bus window leaks inhospitably but reveals a beautiful view. We have passed quickly from desert through arable land to pasture, and the ground is now green with grass, the slopes dark with pine. A few cattle drink at a clear stream flowing past moss-covered stones; it is a Constable landscape.

The stream changes into a white torrent, and as we climb higher I wish more and more that I had brought with me something warmer than the pair of shorts that have served me so well in the desert. The stream (which, we are told rises in **Heaven Lake**) disappears, and we continue our slow ascent. About noon, we arrive at **Heaven Lake**, and look for a place to stay at the foot, which is the resort area. We get a room in a small cottage, and I am happy to note that there are thick quilts on the beds.

Standing outside the cottage we survey our surroundings. **Heaven Lake** is long, sardine-shaped and fed by snowmelt from a stream at its head. **The lake** is an intense blue, surrounded on all sides by green mountain walls, dotted with distant sheep. At the head of **the lake**, beyond the delta of the inflowing stream, is a massive snow-capped peak which dominates the vista; it is part of a series of peaks that culminate, a little out of view, in Mount Bogda itself.

For those who live in the resort there is a small mess-hall by the shore. We eat here sometimes, and sometimes buy food from the vendors outside, who sell kabab and naan until the last buses leave. The kababs, cooked on skewers over charcoal braziers, are particularly good; highly spiced and well-done. Horse's milk is available too from the local Kazakh herdsman, but I decline this. I am so affected by the cold that Mr. Cao, the relaxed young man who runs the mess, lends me a spare pair of trousers, several sizes too large but more than comfortable. Once I am warm again, I feel a pre-dinner spurt of energy – dinner will be long in coming – and I ask him whether **the lake** is good for swimming in.

Qus.1. What is the protagonist wearing in the bus?

- (a) A dhoti
- (b) Trousers
- (c) A pair of shorts
- (d) Long sleeved shirt

Ans. C

Sol. **Point 3:** Pay attention where a paragraph ends and the next paragraph starts. Starting lines of the third paragraph: The stream changes into a white torrent, and as we climb higher *I wish more and more that I had brought with me something warmer than the pair of shorts* that have served me so well in the desert.

Qus.2. What is the most appropriate ANTONYM of 'accept' from the passage?

- (a) Reject
- (b) Refuse
- (c) Decline
- (d) Turn down

Ans. C

Sol. **Point 1:** Answer this question first in the exam while you're reading the questions. You don't need to read the passage most of the time to answer these types of questions.

Qus.3. Select the most appropriate title for the passage.

- (a) Shorts to Trousers
- (b) Lake Heaven
- (c) Peasant Life
- (d) Journey to Mount Bogda

Ans.b

Sol. **Point 2:** For the title question, *always focus on repeating words*. You can see that the word 'Heaven Lake' is repeated here many times. No other option is getting repeated more than Heaven Lake. This is your title. It takes a little practice, but you'll be able to answer it correctly every time.

Qus.4. What is the tone of the passage?

- (a) Romantic
- (b) Angry
- (c) Serene
- (d) Agitated

Ans. C

Sol. **Point 5:** First of all, eliminate negative tone options (angry, agitated, sad, etc.). "In SSC, tone is usually neutral or positive unless the author clearly criticizes, complains, or expresses concern."

In this case, the tone is also not romantic (there is no romance in the passage, it's about a lake), which leaves us with one option (Serene = Calm & peaceful), so this is the correct answer.

Last or second last paragraph hints us about the tone and theme of the passage. In this case, the second last paragraph tells us about the tone. The author uses descriptive language to paint a tranquil picture of the surroundings, such as "fields of sunflowers," "clear stream flowing past moss-covered stones," and "Heaven Lake is long, sardine-shaped and fed by snowmelt." These descriptions evoke a sense of peace and beauty.

Passage - 2 (Previous Year)

A new and extreme tourist attraction has just exploded on to the scene in Iceland: **Volcano Walking**. It would appear, according to Trip Advisor, that this is one trip that cannot be missed, despite the extortionate cost.

The idea of making **Thrihnukagigur volcano** accessible was the brainchild of Ami B. Stefansson, a doctor in Reykjavik and a lifelong cave enthusiast. He has been studying caves in Iceland since 1954 and some would argue that there is no-one who has more experience. Thrihnukagigur has always been special to Stefansson ever since he was the first to descend down to the crater base in 1974. Like most people who experience it, he was utterly spellbound by its uniqueness and beauty and made it his mission to protect and preserve this stunning natural phenomenon. Unlike others who may have only seen the profit that could be made from walking into the mouth of a **volcano**, Stefansson believed that the primary focus was to treat such a grand natural wonder with the utmost respect, to protect and defend it. The first '**volcano tourists**' entered the **volcano** in 2005 and it has since been labelled as one of the most unique tourist attractions in the world.

Volcano walkers are taken to the mouth of the crater from where they are lowered in a basket into the depths of the earth. People once thought that volcanoes were portals to Hell and associated with death and destruction and yet the entrance to the crater is awe-inspiring and almost ethereal. The vastness of it can feel overwhelming; it is the size of a cathedral and the Statue of Liberty could easily fit into the shaft. After 6 minutes and 120 metres, visitors arrive at the crater base. The ground space is the size of three full-sized basketball courts placed next to each other.

At the bottom there is a reverent hush. People whisper in respect to the sleeping giant who has lain dormant for 4,000 years. The subterranean walls are scorched with colours from a divine palette: magenta red, vibrant purple, burnt orange, vivid green and honey yellow. The colour intensifies in certain places where 4000 years ago the magma was pushed out with brutal force.

This is Mother Nature's secret place, her private art studio where visitors feel like trespassers. The protruding rock faces show a tapestry of patterns and formations that have been molded by heat, pressure and time. Floodlights illuminate the walls and draw attention to the beauty humans were never intended to see. A light rain weeps from the porous rock above and covers the crater sides with a shine that makes it sparkle. The scorch marks can be seen close up - at one point in time these rock faces were glowing red with fiery heat. This giant, although sleeping, is still dangerous: an 80-metre drop into the void is disguised by a collection of rocks close to where visitors stand.

It is a soul-enriching experience and visitors often report feeling deeply moved by the beauty and tranquillity of something that was once so destructive and angry. Confronted with this result of the unrestrained forces of nature, it is hard not to feel small and powerless in comparison. Sadly, the magical spell is broken when the basket appears, indicating that it is time for visitors to return to reality. On the return hike, visitors walk across the lava fields as though they are astronauts on the moon. They pass enormous open wounds where the landscape is literally tearing itself apart as tectonic plates slowly shift. It serves as one final reminder that this giant is merely dormant, not dead.

Qus.1. The tone of the passage is -

- (a) Formal
- (b) Laudatory
- (c) Satirical
- (d) Apathetic

Ans. B

Sol. **Point 5:** The passage is about volcano walking/visiting (because the word 'volcano' is repeated many times). We can eliminate options A, C and D. It is not satirical (criticizing people or ideas in a humorous way) or apathetic (having no interest or desire). It is also not formal (sophisticated vocabulary, complex sentence structures, and maintains a serious or authoritative tone). It is laudatory (praising, admiring). It admires/praises the volcano visit.

Last or second last paragraph hints us about the tone and theme of the passage. In this case, the following lines of the last paragraph tells us about the tone: *It is a soul-enriching experience and visitors often report feeling deeply moved by the beauty and tranquillity of the volcano.*

Qus.2. The volcano is referred to as the 'sleeping giant' in the passage because -

- (a) It is very deep
- (b) It is an active volcano
- (c) It is very destructive
- (d) It is a dormant volcano

Ans. D

Sol. **Point 3:** Pay attention where a paragraph ends and the next paragraph starts. The starting lines of the fourth paragraph tell us about it: *People whisper in respect to the sleeping giant who has lain dormant for 4,000 years.*

Qus.3. The given passage is a ----- passage.

- (a) Narrative
- (b) Literary
- (c) Descriptive
- (d) Didactic

Ans. C

Sol. The passage talks about visiting a volcano in details and gives us the complete description. So it's a descriptive passage.

- Descriptive = providing a complete description, explanation with many details
- Narrative = A narrative passage tells a story or describes a series of events—real or fictional—using characters (I, we, he, any name, etc.), setting, conflict, and a clear sequence, typically following a beginning, middle, and end structure
- Literary = a piece from a work of fiction, poetry, or drama, often used to test comprehension of tone, theme, and character emotions rather than just facts
- Didactic = a piece of writing specifically designed to teach, instruct, or give a moral lesson, often with a formal, authoritative, or informative tone

Qus.4. What feelings do visitors have when they visit the volcano?

- (a) Fear
- (b) Reverence
- (c) Indifference
- (d) Anger

Ans. B

Sol. **Point 3:** Pay attention where a paragraph ends and the next paragraph starts. The starting lines of the fourth paragraph: *At the bottom there is a reverent hush. People whisper in respect to the sleeping giant....*

Qus.5. Who came up with the idea of making the volcano accessible to tourists?

- (a) Thrihnukagigur
- (b) Trip Advisor
- (c) Reykjavik
- (d) Ami B. Stefansson

Ans. D

Sol. **Point 3:** Pay attention where a paragraph ends and the next paragraph starts. The starting lines of the second paragraph: *The idea of making Thrihnukagigur volcano accessible was the brainchild of Ami B. Stefansson, a doctor in Reykjavik and a lifelong cave enthusiast.*

Qus.6. How do tourists reach the base of the crater?

- (a) They descent in a basket
- (b) They go across lava fields
- (c) They go through tectonic plates
- (d) They walk down

Ans. A

Sol. **Point 3:** Pay attention where a paragraph ends and the next paragraph starts. The starting lines of the third paragraph: *Volcano walkers are taken to the mouth of the crater from where they are lowered in a basket into the depths of the earth.*

Passage - 3 (Previous Year)

The number of **Indian students going abroad for higher studies** has increased by 68.79 per cent in the past year, according to data provided by the Minister of State in the Ministry of Education, Subhas Sarkar. As per the data provided by him in the Lok Sabha, the number of Indians enrolled in foreign varsities increased from 4.44 lakh in 2021 to 7.5 lakh in 2022. He clarified that while the Bureau of Immigration and Ministry of Home Affairs maintain departure and arrival data of Indians, there is no index for capturing the category of Indians going abroad for higher education.

“Purpose of Indians going abroad for higher education is captured manually based either on their verbal disclosure or the type of visa of the destination country produced by them at the time of immigration clearance,” Sarkar said.

According to the data provided by the ministry, the number of Indian nationals increased from 4.54 lakh in 2017 to 5.17 lakh in 2018. There was a significant increase in 2019 as well, with 5.86 lakh students flying out of the country. However, during the Covid pandemic, the number of Indian nationals in foreign varsities saw a drastic dip as only 2.59 lakh students were registered. While the number continued to remain low, it saw a slight increase in 2021 with 4.44 lakh registrations. However, the number has significantly jumped to 7.5 lakh in 2022.

The increase in the number of Indian nationals abroad corresponds with the latest immigration reports from some of the popular study-abroad destinations such as the US, UK, and Australia. For the UK, the Immigration Statistics Report states that 127,731 visas were granted to Indian students in September 2022, an increase of 93,470 (+273 per cent) against 34,261 in 2019. Similarly, in the US, the number of Indian students has more than doubled, and the Open Doors Report 2022 has predicted that the number of Indian students heading to America is likely to surpass those from China in 2022-23.

Qus.1. In 2019, how many Indian students went abroad?

- (a) 5.17 lakh
- (b) 4.54 lakh
- (c) 5.86 lakh
- (d) 4.44 lakh

Ans. C

Sol. **Point 4:** Don't waste time reading the data (year, money, %, rates, numbers, etc.). You can easily see where 2019 is given in the passage. Find it, answer it.

Qus.2. Which of the following countries is not very popular with Indian students for studies?

- (a) Australia
- (b) UK
- (c) USA
- (d) China

Ans. D

Sol. It is a question of general knowledge. Indians prefer going to Australia, UK, US mostly than China. Also **Point 3:** Pay attention where a paragraph ends and the next paragraph starts. The starting lines of the fourth paragraph: The increase in the number of Indian nationals abroad corresponds with the

latest immigration reports from *some of the popular study-abroad destinations such as the US, UK, and Australia.*

Qus.3. How do we know the number of students getting visas for studies in UK?

- (a) from the records of Ministry of Home Affairs
- (b) from the Immigration Statistics Report
- (c) from the records of the Bureau of Immigration
- (d) from the Ministry of Education

Ans. B

Sol. **Point 7 and Point 3:** Focus on Capital words/names and where the paragraph changes. The fourth paragraph tells us about it: *For the UK, the Immigration Statistics Report states that 127,731 visas were granted to Indian students.....*

Qus.4. The passage is mainly about -

- (a) Immigration of Indians to UK, US, and Australia
- (b) Indians enrolled in foreign universities
- (c) Indians going to America for higher studies
- (d) Indians going abroad for higher studies

Ans. D

Sol. This question is about the main idea/topic/point of the passage. **Point 1 and Point 2:** The first and the second paragraphs tell us about it.

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